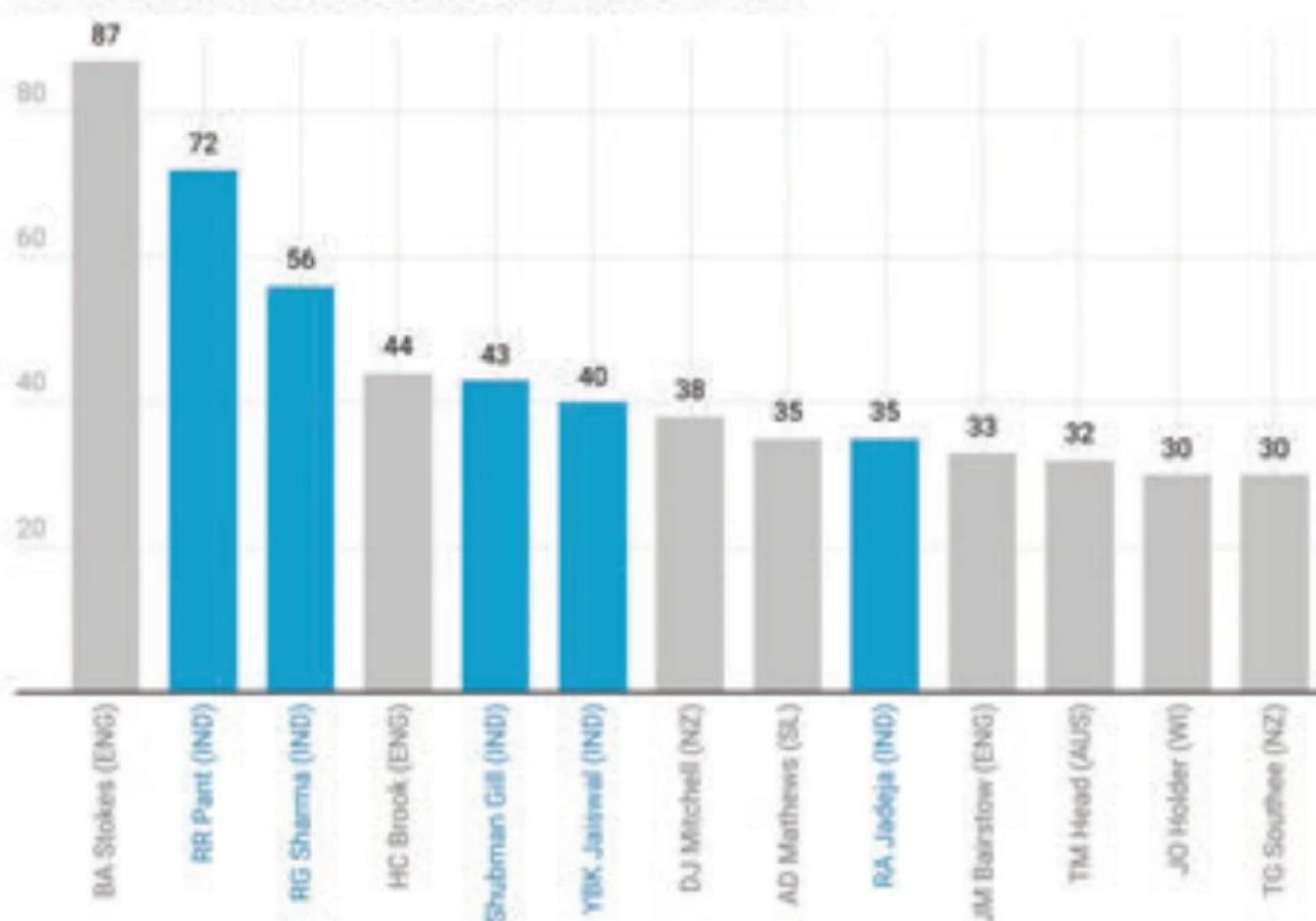
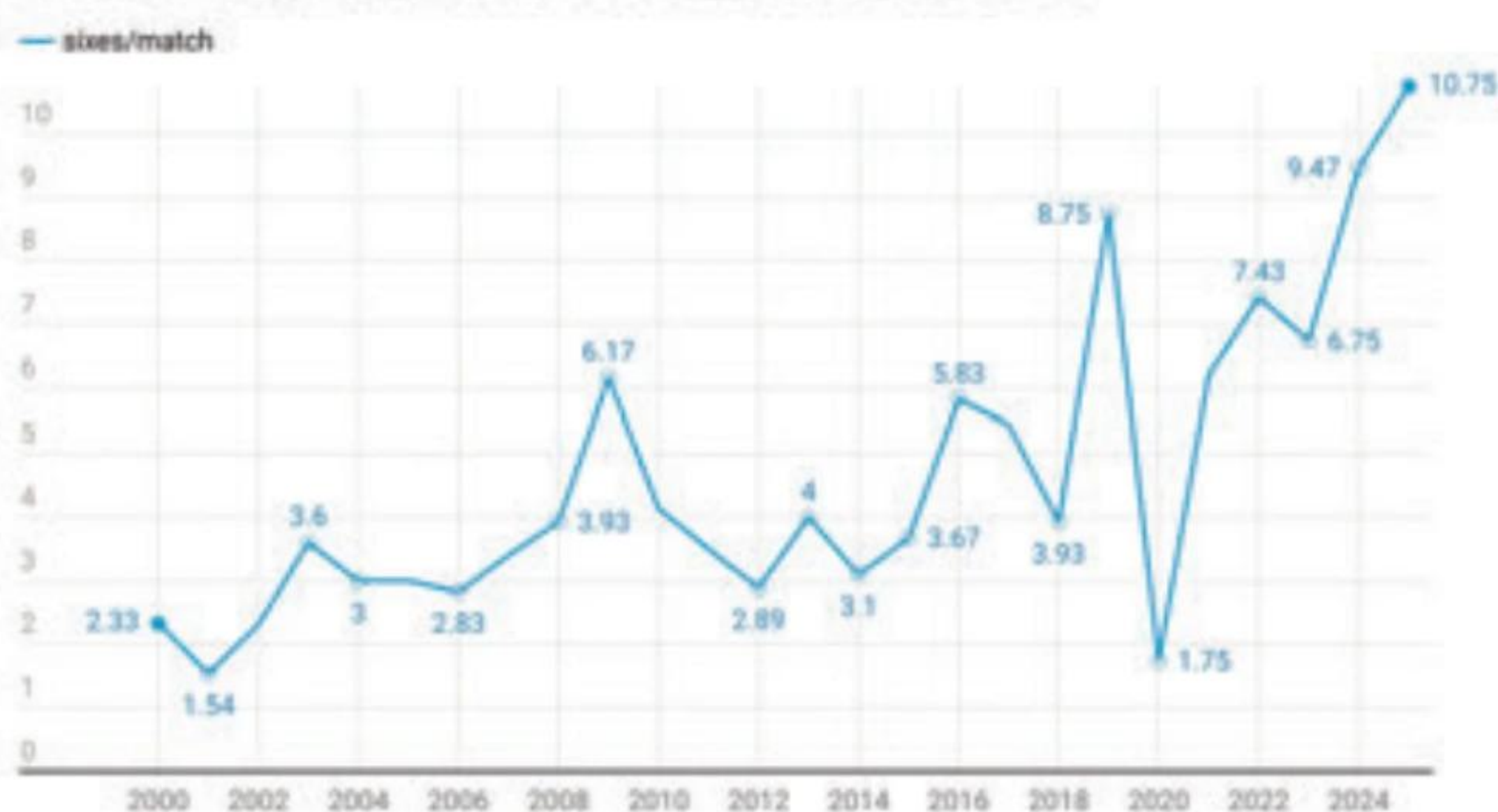


Most sixes in Test cricket since 2019



India's sixes/matches in Test cricket since 2000



below 50 per cent in the 1990s.

In the 2000s, it dropped further to 38.68 per cent, as batting-friendly conditions across the globe made boundary scoring a more viable prospect.

It helped that India was revelling in a golden generation of batters. Four Indians featured in the top 10 for most fours scored in the decade – Rahul Dravid, Sachin Tendulkar, Virender Sehwag and V.V.S Laxman.

More than 50 per cent of India's runs in that decade came through fours. Sixes contributed just 3.46 per cent, with Sehwag accounting for the lion's share. The opening batter smashed 75 maximums and was the

only Indian in the top 10 of that list.

The 2010s saw a mini-resurgence in running between the wickets, thanks in no small part to Virat Kohli, Cheteshwar Pujara and Ajinkya Rahane. Among batters with the most non-boundary runs in that decade, Kohli ranked third and Pujara ninth.

A major shift in approach came in 2019 following Rohit Sharma's induction as Test opener. The Mumbai batter went on a six-hitting spree, tonking 20 maximums in just five Tests – the most by any batter that year.

Rohit successfully transposed his fluent white-ball strokeplay to the

longer format. As a Test opener, he has accumulated 56 sixes from just 38 matches. Following in his footsteps, the next generation of Indian batters began clearing the fence with greater frequency.

Since the start of 2019, 13 batters have hit at least 30 sixes in Test cricket. Five of them are Indians – Rohit, Rishabh Pant, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Shubman Gill and Ravindra Jadeja. The latter is a surprising presence, considering he has a sub-50 strike rate since the turn of the decade.

Soon, India's sixes-per-Test count surged, staying above six in every year since 2019 – except for the COVID-affected 2020. Since the start of the current decade, India has hit more sixes than any other side (385), and at a better rate – 7.40 per match, which is 1.40 more than second-placed New Zealand.

Current vice-captain Pant has been the team's leading aggressor, hitting more fours and sixes than any other Indian batter since 2020.

The wicketkeeper-batter has bludgeoned 70 sixes in 35 matches at a rate of 1.11 per innings – the second-highest for any batter with at least 15 sixes in this period.

Not far behind Pant is Jaiswal, who has struck 40 sixes in just 22 matches since his debut.

The year 2024, in particular, was fruitful for the southpaw, who plundered 888 runs in boundaries across 15 games – the fourth-highest in a single year.

India's boundary-seeking approach, influenced significantly by T20 cricket, is a strategy fraught with risk. When it works, it can blow the opposition out of the water – as seen at Edgbaston, where India launched 19 sixes en route to a massive win.

But on juicier surfaces, where six-hitting becomes harder and old-school accumulation proves more effective, India has struggled – as seen at Lord's.

Since the start of 2024, India has failed to register a six in its innings only three times – in Brisbane (vs Australia), in Bengaluru (vs New Zealand) and in Hyderabad (vs England) – and lost all three matches.